

Chapter 4

“No cracks in the bottleneck!”: A cartographic model for the derivation of non-V2 in German

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This paper discusses the derivation of syntactic patterns of present-day German that appear to linearly violate the V2 constraint within the cartographic model and draws insights into the inner structure of the left periphery in this language. It is proposed that these apparent non-V2 arrangements are derivable by means of a limited number of syntactic operations (combining Merge and Move) that do not put into question the classical account of German as a structural V2 language. In particular, the article makes the following claims: (i) the attested V3 and other Verb-Later orders are to be categorized as variants of V2 that are derived according to principles that are compatible with the a/m operations; (ii) German also exhibits a Split CP that is similar – *mutatis mutandis* – to that of Modern Romance, but makes use of different derivational strategies to achieve the relevant linearization(s); (iii) this insight can only be gained if (at least) comparable methods and (at least) comparable theoretical assumptions about the syntax of German are used to interpret the data.

1 Introduction

German is a so-called “asymmetric Verb-Second (V2) language” in which (declarative) main clauses exhibit leftward verb movement from their base-generation site in the VP to some C-head and – typically – raising of a further constituent into a left-peripheral specifier (1).¹ The latter operation is related to the satisfac-

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tion of an EPP(-like) feature (Chomsky 2000, 2001), which, in its most general formulation, corresponds to a formal mechanism requiring that the specifier of the C-domain (in languages like German) be filled by a maximal projection.² Meanwhile, in embedded clauses introduced by an overt subordinating element, instead, the finite verb remains in I° and no XP base-generated in the middle field is moved into the left periphery (2a). This is generally captured in terms of a complementary distribution between the finite verb and a subordinator in C°: if the head of the CP is lexicalized by a complementizer, the presence of this element blocks V-movement into the same position (Höhle 1986) (2b):

- (1) Hans hat gestern Maria geküsst.
 Hans AUX.PRS.3SG yesterday Mary PTCP-kiss-PTCP
 ‘Hans kissed Mary yesterday.’
- (2) a. ...dass Hans gestern Maria geküsst hat.
 that Hans yesterday Mary PTCP-kiss-PTCP AUX.PRS.3SG
- b. * ...dass Hans hat gestern Maria geküsst.
 that Hans AUX.PRS.3SG yesterday Mary PTCP-kiss-PTCP
 (int.): ‘...that Hans kissed Mary yesterday.’

While the V2 status of present-day German is basically uncontroversial, this is not the case for the internal makeup of the left periphery in this language assumed to accommodate the corresponding structures. In the generative literature, a number of proposals have been put forward that seek to combine the above-mentioned generalization and the general principles of transformational grammar in order to answer the question of how complex this clausal domain can be assumed to be in German. Sticking to the key facts sketched in (1) and (2), three of these models are presented in Section 2 before addressing some problematic data and spelling out a theoretical proposal for their derivation in the following sections.

²The exact formulation of the EPP and its structural locus in German are still a matter of controversy in the literature. Here, I follow, e.g., Grewendorf (2002b), Fanselow (2004), Frey (2006), Holmberg (2015) in assuming that movement to Spec,CP (or to one of the CP-specifiers) is brought about by a feature of C° that is saturated by lexicalizing the corresponding specification in declarative main clauses by means of a movement operation or external merge.

2 How to derive V2?

2.1 Three models for the derivation of German main clauses

As mentioned above, over the past decades, three models have been particularly successful in the generative literature as possible theoretical models for the derivation of the word orders shown in (1) and (2) for present-day German (in what follows: M1, M2, and M3). These approaches yield different implications that correspond to different ways of conceiving of the structure of the left periphery in general, as well as the mechanisms leading to surface arrangements in specific languages.

M1 is the classic generative model advocated (in this form) at least since Government & Binding and still fairly popular in the treatment of bona fide V2 languages (cf., e.g., Haider 1993, Lohnstein 2000, Frey 2000, Fuß 2008, Walkden 2017: 165f.). In M1, the left periphery of German consists of only one projection, i.e. one head and one specifier. This representation implies that the CP is understood as an unspecified domain that is compatible with different grammatical and information-structural features. At the same time, the idea of a one-projection CP is in line with the fact that a well-behaved V2 language by definition does not allow for “exceptions to the rule”, that is, arrangements in which the preverbal position is occupied by more than one constituent. In a non-Kaynian (1994) approach to linearization, the verb is base-generated in V^0 , moved to the sentence-final head of the IP to acquire its inflectional features and then moved to C^0 .³ Any type of constituent – bearing e.g. a topic (α), a focus (β), a *wh* (γ) feature, etc.) appearing to the left of the finite verb in the surface syntax is first-merged in the middle field and raised to Spec,CP, as illustrated in Figure 1.

M2 is the one developed within the cartographic model (Rizzi 1997, 2001, 2004, and much subsequent work) (Figure 2). While this paradigm was originally proposed for the representation of the left edge of languages like present-day Italian, it has also been adopted for many other languages and language stages (cf., inter alia, Axel 2007, Axel-Tober 2018, Speyer 2008, Bidese et al. 2012, Petrova 2012, Cognola 2013, Wolfe 2016, 2018, Haegeman & Greco 2018, Hinterhölzl 2017, Speyer & Weiß 2018, De Clercq & Haegeman 2018, Samo 2019, Eska 2020, Greco & Haegeman 2020, Catasso 2021a,c,b). In this model, the left edge of the clause is

³As pointed out by an anonymous reviewer, it should be acknowledged that for German, the very existence of the IP layer has been called into question in the literature, since v-to-T movement in a verb-final clause could be deemed string-vacuous. The reader is referred to Haider (e.g., Haider 1993, 2010) for discussion. In what follows, I adopt a cartographic approach and label the clausal domain below the CP “IP”. However, this detail is not central to the focus of the present study, which primarily centers on the makeup of the left periphery.

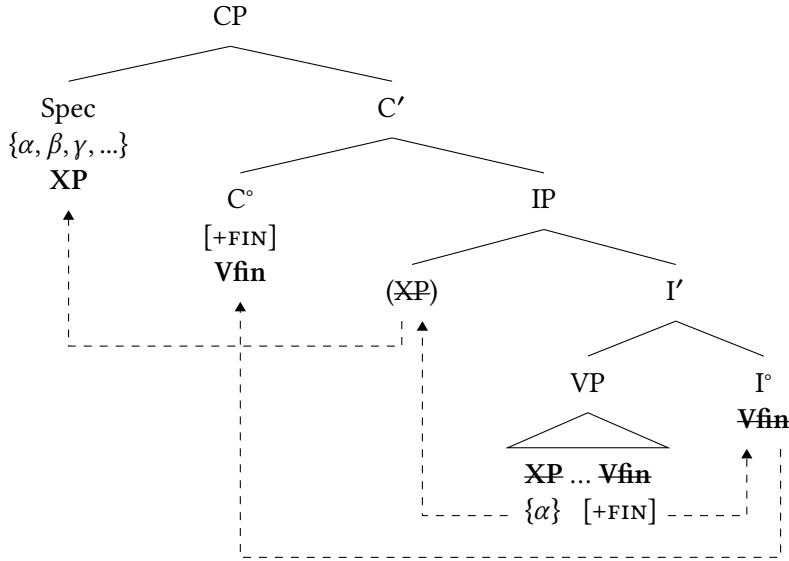


Figure 1: M1: One-projection model for the representation of V2

made up of a cascade of functional projections, each encoding a particular pragmatic, grammatical or information-structural feature. In a nutshell, each projection postulated in Rizzi’s Split CP corresponds to one of the functional traits licensed by the underspecified Spec,CP in the model addressed above. A relevant innovation introduced by the idea of a multi-projectional left periphery is that elements carrying these features occur in a fixed word order in the clause and that the corresponding regularities are cross-linguistically observable (all necessary changes having been made). In the original version given below, ForceP is responsible for clause typing and the interface between sentence and discourse, the two TopPs host (different types of) topics, FocP encodes focus and *wh*-interrogativity, and FinP regulates the relation between the left periphery and the inflectional domain of the clause.

Based on this model, the recent literature has increasingly supported the proposal of a so-called “ForceP V2” in asymmetric V2 languages (cf., inter alia, Polletto 2013, Wolfe 2016, Biberauer & Roberts 2015, 2016, Hinterhölzl 2017). This implementation of main-clause syntax implies obligatory cyclic movement of the finite verb to Fin° and to Force° and raising of *minimally* and *maximally* one constituent to the left periphery via Spec,FinP – in order to derive the so-called “bottleneck effect” (Haegeman 1996) that blocks further movement into the CP domain from the middle-field – followed by movement operations to some higher

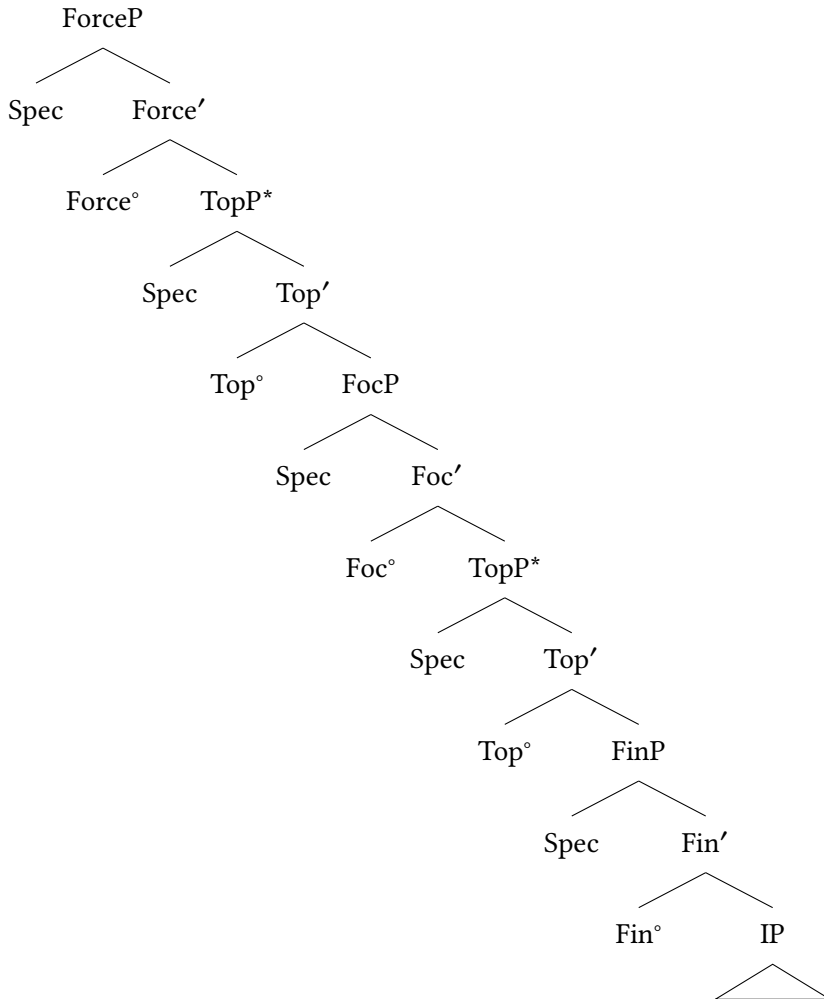


Figure 2: M2: Cartographic model for the CP domain (Rizzi 1997)

specifier and eventually to Spec,ForceP, as illustrated in Figure 3. This analysis represents an elegant attempt to combine the idea that, even in strict V2 languages, the CP layer has a complex inner makeup and the fact that the preverbal specifier can only be targeted by one maximal projection in these systems.

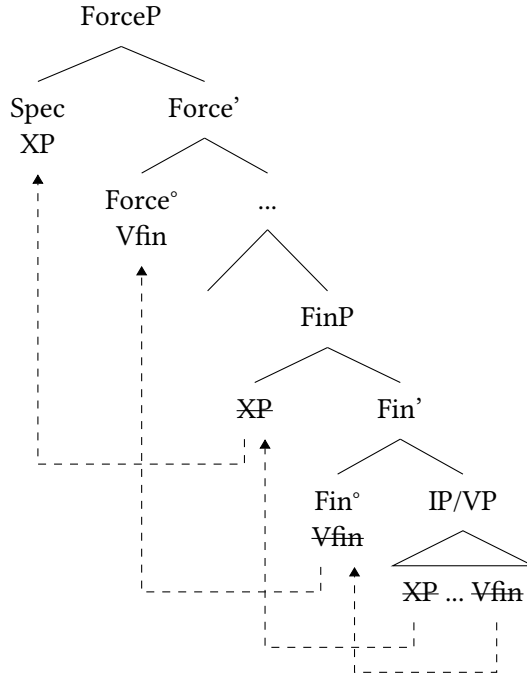


Figure 3: Derivation of ForceP V2

A third option for a formalization of the left periphery (of German) is M3 in Figure 4. This approach results from a revision of the original one-projection model (Figure 1) and has been very successful at least since Chomsky's (1995) minimalist turn (also cf. Bobaljik 1999, Chomsky 2000, Richards 2001; for German, Grewendorf 2002b,a, Rezac 2004, Lahne 2009, G. Müller 2010; for a similar implementation with respect to historical stages and urban varieties of German, Fuß 2008, Walkden 2014, 2017; for a similar idea within a theory of CP recursion, also cf. Iatridou & Kroch 1992, Vikner 2017, etc.).

M3 is based on the idea that the CP layer can be recursively expanded to make room for additional material, but that this operation only involves the Spec position, so that the left edge of a clause consists of *one* projection, viz. one head, and as many specifiers as are needed. An important implication of this model is that each non-head position within the CP resulting from recursive applications of

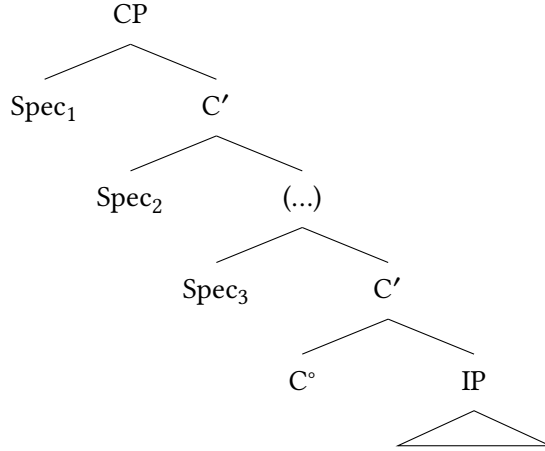


Figure 4: M3: CP-recursion model of the left periphery

Merge, is specialized in the encoding of one specific feature (say, α = Frame, β = Familiar Topic), which ensures that only some linearizations are possible, while others are excluded, and that the finite verb is attracted to the head position C° .⁴ This is schematically illustrated in Figure 5.

M1, M2 and M3 originate from divergent conceptions of the internal makeup of the left periphery and the derivation of syntactic structures, but are in principle all perfectly compatible with the simple asymmetric-V2 system illustrated for present-day German in (1).

What seems to be problematic in relation to the derivation of syntactic structures in this language is the fact that it allows for a number of linear phenomena that seem to challenge each of the models presented in this section. In order to account for every possible canonical and non-canonical word order, it is therefore necessary to consider how maximally complex (and still grammatical) structures can be derived in German without violating the V2 constraint.

⁴It is to be noted, however, that not all proposals based on the idea of CP recursion treat feature encoding in the same way: in Walkden's (2017) model, which includes two C-layers, each CP has its own head and the lower CP roughly corresponds to FinP, while the higher one includes all features from FocP upwards.

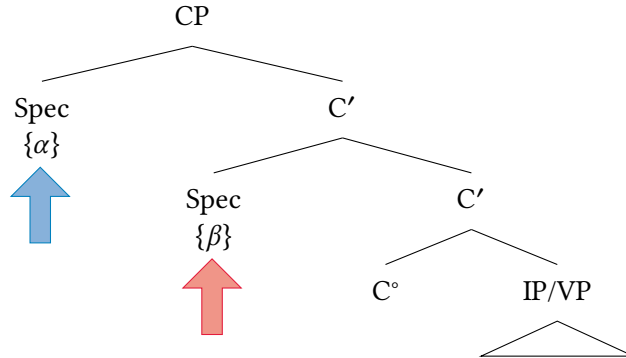


Figure 5: Feature encoding in CP recursion

2.2 Scope of the paper

In consideration of the options presented above, the aim of this paper is to draw attention on so-called “non-V2” or “Verb-Late(r)” phenomena of German, i.e. linear V3, V4, etc., and to propose a model for the derivation of a number of phenomena superficially incompatible with the descriptive notion of V2.

In what follows, it will be proposed that the most appropriate model to account for the data observable in German is M2, i.e. that this language has – *mutatis mutandis* – a Split CP à la Rizzi. It will be shown that V2 is (the product of) an all-structural, not linear constraint, and does not result from the lexicalization of ForceP, but from V-to-Fin movement implying a simultaneous derivation of the bottleneck effect and satisfaction of an EPP(-like) feature in this projection resulting from a combination of Move and Merge.

In a nutshell, all V3, V4 etc. patterns attested at different levels of the language represent linear variants of V2 that are operationalized according to the very same principles and do not require *ad hoc* postulations about the makeup of the left periphery or the status of the individual phenomena.

The rest of the paper is structured as follows: in Section 3, the relevant German data linearly violating the V2 restriction described above are presented. In Section 4, a uniform model is proposed on the basis of M2 that attempts to derive all possible Verb-Late(r) patterns by considering not only the single phenomena, but also their interaction in the left periphery of the clause. Section 5 concludes.

3 V3 as a window into the structure of the left periphery

As mentioned in Section 2, German exhibits a number of main-clause phenomena which – at least from a linear perspective – deviate from the V2 constraint. In particular, there exist constructions in which the prefield, namely the intrasentential portion of the clause preceding the finite verb, is occupied by more than one element, as has been noticed in a considerable amount of literature in the last decades (cf., among many others, Lee 1975, van de Velde 1978, Lühr 1985, Cardinaletti 1989, Auer 1996, 1997, St. Müller 2003, 2005, 2023 Frey 2004, Eggs 2004, Speyer 2008, Breindl 2011, Müller et al. 2012, Schalowski 2015, Speyer & Weiß 2018, S. Müller 2019, Bunk 2020, Wiese et al. 2020, Catasso 2021a, Breitbarth 2022, 2023, Axel-Tober 2023). This does not seem to be in line with the very nature of V2 itself, which imposes a limit of one (moved or merged) full XP per CP domain.

As the examples in (3) and (4) show, V3 is attested in different configurations. The sentences in (3) instantiate correlative Verb-Late(r) constructions, i.e. sequences in which the finite component of the verbal predicate formally surfaces in third position and the two elements in the prefield are co-referential. The structure in (3a) is a left dislocation: a fronted DP is taken up by a pronominal resumptive (glossed as *P.RES* here and in what follows) in preverbal position replicating its φ -features. (3b) illustrates adverbial resumption: similarly to DP left dislocation, an adjunct occurs in first clause position and is resumed by an adverbial element (*A.RES*) to the left of the finite verb in C. Both patterns raise the question as to how it is possible to accommodate the left-dislocated phrase and the resumptive in the preverbal area:

- (3) a. Den Hans, den kenne ich seit langem.
the-ACC.SG Hans P.RES.ACC.SG know.PRS.1SG I-NOM.SG since long
‘I have known Hans for a long time.’ (Cardinaletti 1989: 9)
- b. Wenn Sie den Job haben wollen, dann
if you-NOM.SG.POL the-ACC.SG job have-INF want-PRS.3PL A.RES
müssen Sie ein bisschen auf den Punkt
must.PRS.3PL you-NOM.SG.POL a little to the-ACC.SG point
kommen.
come-INF
‘If you want the job, you need to get to the point.’ (adapted from: Auer 2000: 5)

A further group of V3 phenomena includes different non-correlative patterns, like the ones exemplified in (4). In (4a), a clausal (here: conditional) adjunct precedes the *wh*-interrogative *warum* ('why') in preverbal position. (4b) features an argument to the left of a so-called "post-initial particle" marking the fronted constituent – depending on the information-structural context – as an aboutness or contrastive topic. In (4c) and (4d), two variants of what seems to be the same pattern are illustrated: in (4c) a frame(-like) adjunct⁵ appears before an argument (the subject of the sentence), in (4d) the argument surfaces in a higher position than the adjunct (here: a temporal adverbial clause). In (4e), two distinct adverbials, the temporally-interpreted PP *am Nachmittag* ('in the afternoon') and the locative PP *in einem Gang...* ('in an alley...'), which clearly have different references, both occur in preverbal position:

- (4) a. (Eggs 2004: 346)
 [Wenn sie schon so ... viel Geld gewonnen
 if they-NOM already so much money PTCP-win-PTCP
 haben,] [warum] spendieren sie nicht wenigstens
 AUX.PRS.3PL why pay-PRS.3PL they-NOM NEG at-least
 eine Runde?
 one-ACC.SG round
 'If they have won so much money, why don't they at least pay for a round?'
- b. (Breindl 2011: 18)
 [Dieses Raster] [nun] entspricht in einer
 this-NOM.SG grid now correspond-PRS.3SG in a-DAT.SG
 gewissen Weise einem Enzym.
 certain-DAT.SG way a-DAT.SG enzyme
 'In a way, this grid corresponds to an enzyme.'

⁵Frame setters are expressions that provide the setting within which the predicate of the clause is to be interpreted (Chafe 1976, Krifka 2006, Jacobs 2001). This notion can be understood in different ways. In the present discussion, I will refer to frame setters as to any type of adjunct (i.e., phrase that is not part of the verb's argument structure) occurring in the CP domain that introduces a background. This background can be realized by a prototypical local or temporal adverbial, but also by a more abstract category (conditionality, concessiveness, causality, finality, etc.). A conditional clause, for instance, does not introduce a deixis localized in the actual world, but it projects the content of the clause into a parallel world, thus providing an abstract local/temporal reference for the sentence. Similarly, a fronted causal adjunct encloses the action or condition described by the predicate in a certain (presupposed) state of affairs resulting from a cause-and-effect relation, and so on.

- c. (Breitbarth 2022: 8)
 [Heute,] [die Goethe-Institute in Indien]
 today the-NOM.PL Goethe-institute-NOM.PL in India
 heißen alle Max Müller Bhavan.
 be-called-PRS.3PL all-NOM-PL Max Müller Bhavan
 ‘Today, all Goethe Institutes in India are called “Max Müller Bhavan”.’
- d. (Lee 1975: 120)
 [Piachi,] [als ihm der Stab gebrochen
 Piachi when he-DAT.SG the-NOM.SG staff PTCP-break-PTCP
 war,] verweigerte sich hartnäckig der
 AUX.PST.3SG refuse-PST.3SG REFL.ACC.3SG stubbornly the-DAT.SG
 Absolution.
 absolution
 ‘Piachi, when the staff was broken over him, stubbornly refused
 absolution.’
- e. (Müller 2003: 38, quoted from: van de Velde 1978: 35)
 [Am Nachmittag] [in einem Gang zwischen
 in-the-DAT.SG afternoon in a-DAT.SG alley between
 Ladenhäusern] ließ B sich das
 shop-house-DAT.PL let-PST.3SG B REFL.DAT.3SG the-ACC.SG
 Flugticket geben.
 flight-ticket give-INF
 ‘In the afternoon, in an alley between buildings, he received the flight
 ticket.’

In light of the current debate, both the correlative and the non-correlative patterns exemplified above are problematic for a number of reasons. From a theoretical point of view, not only is the internal makeup of the left periphery of German a hotly debated subject (see Section 2.1); there does also not seem to be consensus on the syntactic and semantic status of the elements occupying the prefield in these sentences – for instance, on how to derive resumptive structures like (3a–3b), on whether adverbials like those in (4a–4c) occur in an intra- or extrasentential projection and whether they are moved or merged into their surface position, and on which criteria should be considered in order to determine if element like post-initial *nun* in (4b) are maximal projections or heads.

Moreover, most studies investigating V3 in German include analyses of single patterns – e.g., only the derivation of left dislocation, or only the derivation of

contrastive topics marked by a post-initial element – and do not consider their interaction within the left periphery. Given that in the majority of cases neither the derivational mechanisms leading to the relevant linearizations nor the individual analyses are shared by the linguists' community, it follows that the theoretical results are not necessarily comparable.

In Section 4, the attempt will be made to derive the different phenomena considered in (3) and (4) within the same theoretical model and to propose a comprehensive model for the formalization of all observable V2 and Verb-Late(r) data in German, including those involving multiple V3 phenomena simultaneously. This proceeds from the idea that only an approach that makes use of the same assumptions and tools of analysis to account for the relevant facts can reduce all linear instances of V2, V3, V4, etc. to the same common denominator.

4 A cartographic model for the left periphery of German

In this section, a theoretical model will be presented that aims to allow for an exhaustive treatment of unmarked V2 linearizations, as well as of non-V2 patterns. It will be proposed that the only sensible way of dealing with this kind of variability is to assume a Split CP à la Rizzi (1997) (the cartographic M2 in Section 2) and to adapt this to the observable regularities of German.

The following technical details will be assumed in what follows for reasons to become apparent below:

- in present-day German, V2 is basically an instantiation of V-to-C movement. There is no IP V2 (pace Travis 1984);
- it is FinP that carries the EPP(-like) feature, thus attracting the finite verb from its base-generation site in V°;
- V2 in well-behaved V2 languages is subject to a bottleneck effect (Section 2.1 and (5–6)): only one XP can move into the left periphery, and this operation is mediated by FinP, whose specifier is *always* filled by a trace in declarative main clauses (5a–5b). If it is the case that the preverbal position is occupied by an expletive (6a), this element is first-merged into Spec,FinP (6b). For ease of representation, in (5) and (6) only the derivation of the preverbal phrase is considered.

- (5) a. Den Keks hat Peter schon gegessen.
 the-ACC.SG biscuit AUX.PRS.3SG Peter already PTCP-eat-PTCP
 'Peter has already eaten the biscuit.'
- b. [_{YP} *den Keks*_i [_{FinP} *t_i* [_{IP/VP} *t_i*]]]]

- (6) a. Es regnet.
 EXPL rain-PRS.3SG
 ‘It’s raining.’
 b. [_{FinP} es [_{IP/VP}]]

Before going into the details of the interplay between the non-V2 patterns illustrated in the previous section, the derivation of left dislocation and constructions involving post-initial markers will be addressed in Section 4.1.

4.1 Derivation of left dislocation and post-initial particles

Two linear non-V2 phenomena that provide crucial evidence for identifying the positions in which information structure is mapped onto the syntactic representation in the CP domain are left dislocation and post-initial markers.

4.1.1 Pronominal and adverbial left dislocation

With respect to the former, it can be assumed that resumptive constructions with a fronted DP (7a) and a fronted adverbial (7b) have the same underlying derivation, since these two patterns are united by a number of common properties: they both realize a strategy to introduce a topic in the discourse (an aboutness or contrastive topic in nominal left dislocation, a frame-setting topic in adverbial resumption), the construction includes a left-peripheral resumptive in preverbal position that is only possible in main clauses and in embedded clauses with root-like properties,⁶ and this element is fully optional. In the case of *d*-resumptives (7a), which take up the reference of a preposed nominal expression, and of the specialized resumptive *da* (7b) (Meklenborg 2020, Meklenborg & Lohn-dal 2023), which is compatible with local and temporal antecedents, this optionality is purely register-based: the variant with the resumptive is typically produced in spoken/colloquial German, while the resumptiveless one characterizes

⁶As for un-introduced embedded clauses, Bayer (2001) provides the following example in which the left-dislocated constituent tops an object clause that is not selected by a complementizer. Such a structure can be assumed to be “root-like” for at least two reasons: (i) from a semantic point of view, it complements a doxastic predicate (*glauben* ‘believe’) compatible with a semi-assertive reading of the subordinate clause (cf., e.g., Reis 1997, Auer 1998, Meinunger 2004, Truckenbrodt 2006, Freywald 2013, Petrova 2020); (ii) syntactically, it does not contain a lexicalized complementizer; if that were the case, the conjunction would block any movement or merge into the left periphery of the clause:

- (i) (Bayer 2001: 24)
 Ich glaube, den Hans, den kennt er kaum.
 I-NOM believe-PRS.1SG the-ACC.SG Hans P.RES.ACC.SG know-PRS.3SG he-NOM barely
 ‘I think he barely knows Hans.’

the standard language. There is no interpretive difference between the two structures:

- (7) a. Den Hans(, den) kann ich nicht leiden.
 the-ACC.SG Hans P.RES.ACC.SG can-PRS.1SG I-NOM NEG suffer-INF
 ‘I can’t stand Hans.’
- b. Damals(, da) hatten wir Wichtigeres zu
 back-then A.RES have-PST.1PL we-NOM important-COMP.ACC.SG to
 tun.
 do-INF
 ‘Back then, we had more important things to do.’

It is reasonable to assume the following derivation for these patterns (in the spirit of Ross 1967, Cinque 1977, Grohmann 1997, 2000, 2003, Grewendorf 2002b,a, Speyer & Weiß 2018, Catasso 2021a): the phrase surfacing on top of the syntactic tree is base-generated in the relevant middle-field position and cyclically moved to Spec,FinP, where it derives the bottleneck effect, and to some higher specifier, in which it is pronounced, at the end of the process. The latter phase of the derivation will be addressed in more detail in the next paragraphs. What is crucial here is that the resumptive that the moved constituent leaves in Spec,FinP is treated as a trace spell-out, viz. as a trace whose phonetic realization is optional and which replicates the same referential features as the fronted XP. Whether it is pronounced or not, the trace blocks any further movement operation from a lower position and prevents merge of lexical material in the left periphery. The finite verb is moved to Fin.⁷ In this sense, the linear V3 sequence resulting from these operations does not violate the V2 constraint *structurally*, since it involves

⁷As is the case for V3 phenomena in general, a number of alternative implementations have been proposed in the literature for left dislocation. Ott (2014), for instance, assumes left dislocation to derive from a biclausal structure with two juxtaposed CPs in which the higher one is deleted at PF (i). Haider (2010), instead, makes the case that the left-dislocated phrase is pre-adjoined to the clause, i.e., base-generated to the left of the CP (ii):

- (i) (adapted from Ott 2014: 270)
 [_{CP1} [XP]_i [... t_i ...]] [_{CP2} RES_k ... t_k ...]
- (ii) (adapted from Haider 2010: 3)
 [_{FP} XP_j [_{FP} RES_i_j [Vfin [... t_i ...]]]]]

In the present discussion, I will stick to a movement analysis, which I think does better justice both to the parallelism between topicalization without resumption and left dislocation and to the interaction between left-dislocation constructions and other V3 patterns simultaneously occurring in the left periphery (see below).

movement of only one constituent into the prefield. A sketchy representation is given in (8):

- (8) [_{ForceP} [_{YP} [_{XP}]_i ... [_{FinP} [_{RES}]_i [_{Fin°} V_{finj}] [_{IP/VP} t_i ... t_j]]]]

4.1.2 Particles in post-initial position

As far as markers in post-initial position are concerned, it is to be noticed that elements like *aber* ('however'), *hingegen* ('instead'), *beispielsweise* ('for instance'), etc. typically mark fronted contrastive topics (Breindl 2011). In (9), *Maria* and *Hans* are two referents that are selected from a set of alternatives, but are not part of the focus domain of the respective sentences. In this utterance, the contrastive topic in the second conjunct is disambiguated by means of the marker *aber*:

- (9) (Die) Maria war auf der Party. (Den) Hans
 die-NOM.SG Maria be-PST.3SG at the-DAT.SG party the-ACC.SG Hans
 aber habe ich nicht gesehen.
 however AUX.PRS.1SG I-NOM NEG PTCP-see-PTCP
 'Maria was at the party. However, I didn't set eyes on Hans.'

There is unbiased evidence that contrastive topics are moved constituents in German (cf., e.g., Catasso 2021a: 786–787). For instance, in some (western and northern) varieties of the language, prepositional adverbs of the *da*+PREP type (*dafür* 'for that', *dagegen* 'against that', *damit* 'with that', etc.) can optionally be split. Therefore, in contexts like (10), which imply a contrastive reading of the preposed constituent (*da* anaphorically refers back to renting an apartment in Valletta in the pre-context), the referential component of the adverb can surface in the prefield either independently (10a) or together with the preposition (10b):

- (10) *Context*: For our holiday in Malta, Maria has proposed that we could rent an apartment together in the city center of Valletta.
- a. Da habe ich nichts gegen (...aber ich möchte
da have-PRS.1SG I-NOM nothing against but I-NOM want-SBJ.1SG
 mein eigenes Schlafzimmer haben)
 my own-ACC.SG bedroom have-INF
- b. Dagegen habe ich nichts (...aber ich möchte
da-against have-PRS.1SG I-NOM nothing against but I-NOM want-SBJ.1SG
 mein eigenes Schlafzimmer haben)
 my own-ACC.SG bedroom have-INF
 'I have no problem with that (...but I would like to have my own bedroom).'

In sentences like (9) and (10), the fronted phrase arguably moves into the specifier of a left-peripheral projection in which contrastiveness is encoded (a position that has already been independently proposed for German by Frey 2004, who calls the corresponding projection “KontrP”). It is suggested here, following Catasso (2015, 2021a), that the post-initial marker (*aber* in the second conjunct in (9)) is not an XP, but a lexicalization of the head position of this projection, in whose specifier the contrastive topic surfaces at PF. This means that it is base-generated in the position in which it is pronounced. Note that the post-initial particle is fully optional, cannot occupy the left periphery independently⁸ and is only licensed by the presence of a maximal projection to its left. A provisional derivation for a structure like (9) is given in (11). The contrastive projection in the left periphery is neutrally labeled “YP” here:

- (11) [_{ForceP} [_{YP} [_{den} *Hans*]_j [_{Y°} *aber* ... [_{FinP} *t_j* [_{Fin°} *habe_i* [_{IP/VP} *t_j* *ich nicht gesehen t_i*]]]]]]

Also in this case, the base generation of the marker in the left periphery prevents a violation of the structural V2 constraint.⁹

⁸This can be taken to show that “this” *aber* is not to be categorized as the head of an AdvP. This would imply not only that this element could appear in the left periphery independently of a fully-fledged phrase, but also that it could be the constituent triggering V2 in a main clause. However, this is not the case:

- (i) * ... aber habe ich den Hans nicht gesehen.
 but AUX.PRS.1SG I-NOM the-ACC.SG Hans NEG PTCP-see-PTCP
 (int.): ‘...but I did not see Hans.’”

In some approaches (e.g. Weisser 2022), it is proposed that items like *aber* in (9) are coordinating conjunctions surfacing in second position as a result of the application of a prosodic displacement rule. However, while this would in principle be possible for *aber* (which can also be an adversative coordinator meaning ‘but’), the class of elements that can perform this function in post-initial position includes words such as – among many others – *hingegen* ‘instead’ and *freilich* ‘indeed’, which cannot be coordinating conjunctions.

⁹The syntactic derivation of sentence structures featuring post-initial particles has remained a contentious topic and continues to ignite passionate debate within the syntactic community to this day. Some works (e.g. Volodina & Weiß 2010) propose a derivation in which the post-initial marker is base-generated in the middle field and raised to Spec,CP together with the fronted phrase. The approach advocated here seems to be preferable for a number of reasons. One of the problems related to merging an element like *aber* in (9) in the middle field concerns the categorial status of the constituent in first clause position. In Chomsky’s (2013) theory of labeling, when a head and a phrase merge, the head projects, i.e., provides the label for the resulting object. In order to achieve the relevant word order (XP > *aber*; **aber* > XP), the phrase interpreted contrastively is assumed to move into the specifier of *aber*, the latter lexicalizing a

4.1.3 Co-occurrence of dislocation and post-initial particles

The two non-V2 patterns illustrated in Section 4.1 can co-occur in the same sentence. Given the existence of a bottleneck effect and the derivational mechanisms proposed above, the corresponding operations do not violate the structural V2 constraint preventing more than one XP from entering the CP domain. In a structure like (12a), the direct object *den Hans* is first-merged in the relevant middle-field position and cyclically moved to Spec,FinP, where it leaves a trace spelled out as the pronominal correlate, to derive the bottleneck effect and – at the end of the derivation – to Spec,YP (YP being the contrastive projection discussed above), in whose head the post-initial particle is generated.

- (12) a. Den Hans aber, den habe ich nicht
the-ACC.SG Hans however P.RES.ACC.SG AUX.PRS.1SG I-NOM NEG
gesehen.
PTCP-see-PTCP
- b. [_{ForceP} [_{YP} [*den Hans*]_j [_{Y°} *aber* ... [_{FinP} [*den*]_j [_{Fin°} *habe* [_{IP/VP} *ich* *t_j*
nicht gesehen *t_j*]]]]]]

At this point, a further observation should be made. So far, in the discussion of the derivation of left dislocation and post-initial particles, it has been remarked that contrastively interpreted constituents target Spec,YP as their landing site, i.e. that they occur in that position at PF. A closer look at possible constructions featuring such elements, however, suggests that FinP and YP are not the only left-peripheral projections involved in the derivation. Consider, for instance, the following sentence:

- (13) Context: Der Traum, dass Gott auf die Erde komme, ist wahr geworden in Jesus von Nazareth, dem Kind in der Krippe, dem Wanderprediger, Heiler und Helfer. ('The dream of God coming unto the Earth came true in Jesus of Nazareth, the child in the crib, the evangelist, healer and helper.')
- Das Ende aber dieser Geschichte war kein
the-NOM.SG end however this-GEN.SG story be-PST.3SG no-NOM.SG
Traum mehr. Das Ende war am Kreuz.
dream more the-NOM.SG end be-PST.3SG at-the-DAT.SG cross
'The end of this story, however, was not a dream anymore. The end was on the cross.' (*johanniter.de*, March 09th, 2021)

PrtP (Particle Phrase). This would entail that the pronounced linearization would result from movement of a deficient phrase into the left periphery, which is not a licit operation in German. For further arguments in favor of a base generation of the post-initial particle within the CP, cf. Catasso (2015).

In (13), two phases of a story (the beginning, which is presented in the context, and the end in the relevant clause) are contrasted to each other. The contrastive topic opening the second conjunct (*das Ende dieser Geschichte* ‘the end of this story’) appears in a split configuration in which the post-initial particle *aber* intervenes between the DP and its genitival modifier.¹⁰ Since this sequence occurs preverbally and along the lines of what has been said above, it is proposed that the constituent realizing the contrastive topic moves through a further CP-specifier before reaching its landing site in Spec,YP. The corresponding projection is the one in which the constituent acquires a [+TOP] feature qualifying it as an aboutness topic. Further movement into the higher specifier of YP ensures that the constituent checks an additional [+CONTR] feature that enables its reading as a contrastive topic. From this, it follows that contrastive topics are not information-structural simplexes, but result from the addition of two features cyclically acquired in the syntax. The projection encoding the [+TOP] feature is the position in which aboutness topics (i.e., constituents that refer to “what the sentence is about” and are not interpreted contrastively (Reinhart 1981, Frey 2000, 2007, Krifka 2006, Frascarelli & Hinterhölzl 2007)) appear at PF, that is, their landing site in a sentence like (14a) (assuming the relevant pragmatic reading). It corresponds to one of the TopPs assumed by Rizzi (1997) in the clausal left periphery. Of course, since genuine V2 languages only allow for one XP to enter the CP area, (some of) the different TopPs that are simultaneously activatable in

¹⁰Note that the same configuration can be obtained with any other NP/DP modifier or complement, as exemplarily illustrated in the following examples:

- (i) (PP modifier)
Die Mutter aber von Hans war nicht damit einverstanden.
the-NOM.SG mother however of Hans be-PST.3SG NEG with-that happy
‘Hans’ mother, however, was not happy with that.’
- (ii) (CP modifier)
Die Frau aber, die Hans am meisten
the-NOM.SG woman however REL.ACC.SG Hans at-the-DAT.SG more-SUP.DAT.SG
liebte, war nicht damit einverstanden.
love-PST.3SG be-PST.3SG NEG with-that happy
‘The woman whom Hans loved most, however, was not happy with that.’
- (iii) (CP complement)
Die Tatsache aber, dass Hans nicht damit einverstanden war,
the-NOM.SG fact however that Hans NEG with-that happy be-PST.3SG
gab uns Hoffnung.
give-PST.3SG we-DAT hope
‘The fact that Hans was not happy with that, however, gave us hope.’

languages like Italian are conflated into one projection in German.¹¹ A simplified representation of the corresponding derivation, in which the intermediate CP projection encoding aboutness topichood is neutrally labeled “ZP”, is given in (14b):

- (14) a. *Context:* The interlocutor wants to know something about Hans.
Hans hat letztes Jahr seinen ersten Roman
Hans AUX.PRS.3SG last-ACC.SG year his-ACC.SG first-ACC.SG novel
veröffentlicht.
publish-PTCP
‘Hans published his first novel last year.’
b. [_{ForceP} [_{YP} [_{Y°}] [_{ZP} Hans_j [_{Z°}] [_{FinP} [_{Fin°} hat_i [_{IP/VP} letztes Jahr t_j seinen
ersten Roman veröffentlicht t_i]]]]]]]

With respect to more complex structures like (13), the relevant assumption made here is that, given a modified or complemented XP moved to Spec,ZP, if this constituent is interpreted contrastively in its entirety, it can further move to Spec,YP (15a–16a);¹² if, instead, only one part of it (systematically corresponding

¹¹This very assumption derives from the premise that in languages like Italian, the same type of topic can apparently be realized in more than one left-peripheral position. This arguably correlates with the fact that Italian allows for multiple movement from the IP/VP area, and the instantiations of the possible configurations exhibiting more than one, say, aboutness topic in the CP domain depend on a conspiracy of intricate principles at the interface between syntax and information structure that I will not go into here for reasons of space (for an overview, see Rizzi & Bocci 2017). Cf., e.g., the following examples, which represent syntactic minimal pairs of the same sentence (the capitalization of one segment of the non-finite verb signals focus stress):

- (i) [A Gianni,] perché, [la macchina] gliela volete regalaAre?
to Gianni why the car CL.DAT.3SG.M-CL.ACC.3SG.F want-PRS.2PL give-INF
(ii) Perché [a Gianni,] [la macchina] gliela volete regalaAre?
why to Gianni the car CL.DAT.3SG.M-CL.ACC.3SG.F want-PRS.2PL give-INF
(iii) Perché [la macchina,] [a Gianni,] gliela volete regalaAre?
why the car to Gianni CL.DAT.3SG.M-CL.ACC.3SG.F want-PRS.2PL give-INF
‘Why do you want to give the car to Gianni as a gift (and not, for instance, sell it to him)?’

(adapted from: Rizzi & Bocci 2017: 5). This type of configuration is not present in German, which seems to feature only one genuine aboutness-topic projection in its left periphery.

¹²Note that this configuration does not instantiate a violation of Criterial in the strict sense (Rizzi 2006, 2010), since the further leftward movement of the XP is driven by its need to check a (contrastive) feature that is different from the (topical) one that has already been acquired in Spec,ZP. Indeed, this movement operation only takes place if a topic features an additional contrastive feature.

to the left edge in German) receives a contrastive reading, this segment can move to Spec,YP independently of its modifier/complement, which can be left behind in Spec,ZP (15b–16b). If the latter is the case, the corresponding linearization can be obtained by extraposing the modifier/complement, which is obligatorily non-stressed, DP-internally. As expected, post-initial particles can only be spelled out in one position, namely the head of YP:

- (15) a. Das Ende dieser Geschichte aber war
the-NOM.SG end this-GEN.SG story however be-PST.3SG
kein Traum mehr.
no-NOM.SG dream more
- b. Das Ende aber dieser Geschichte war
the-NOM.SG end however this-GEN.SG story be-PST.3SG
kein Traum mehr.
no-NOM.SG dream more
‘The end of this story, however, was not a dream anymore.’
- (16) a. [_{ForceP} [_{YP} [*Das Ende dieser Geschichte*]_j [_{Y°} *aber*] [_{ZP} *t_j* [_{Z°}] [_{FinP} *t_j*
[_{Fin°} *war_i* [_{IP/VP} *t_j kein Traum mehr t_i*]]]]]]
- b. [_{ForceP} [_{YP} [*Das Ende*]_x [_{Y°} *aber*] [_{ZP} [[_{t_x}] *dieser Geschichte*]_j [_{Z°}] [_{FinP}
t_j [_{Fin°} *war_i* [_{IP/VP} *t_j kein Traum mehr t_i*]]]]]]

Also in this case, the trace left in Spec,FinP by the constituent *das Ende dieser Geschichte* on its way to Spec,YP can optionally have a phonetic form, thereby generating the structure in (17a), whose syntactic representation is given in (17b). For the purposes of the present discussion, in (17) only the version of the sentence with the split nominal expression is given. It is tacitly understood that the more unmarked structure with an unsplit DP like in (15a) is always possible:

- (17) a. Das Ende aber dieser Geschichte, das war kein Traum mehr.
- b. [_{ForceP} [_{YP} [*Das Ende*]_x [_{Y°} *aber*] [_{ZP} [[_{t_x}] *dieser Geschichte*]_j [_{Z°}] [_{FinP}
[das]_j [_{Fin°} *war_i* [_{IP/VP} *t_j kein Traum mehr t_i*]]]]]]

Although the resulting linearization is rather complex, it does not involve any violation of the V2 constraint as it was characterized above. The analysis advocated here is not only that the syntactic acquisition of the information-structural feature of contrastiveness is independent of topichood (an idea which is already found in Frey 2004, although with quite a different implementation), but also that the representation of the left periphery in German is necessarily bound to the technicalities of the cartographic model: different information-structural features such as [+TOP] and [+CONTR] are checked in different Split-CP positions

(18), and the inner complexity of the left periphery of German is both confirmed by the empirical data and compatible with the notion of a well-behaved V2 language:

- (18) [ForceP [YP ... [ZP ... [FinP [IP/VP]]]]] [+CONTR] [+TOP]

This featural split of contrastiveness and other grammatical or information-structural attributes is also visible if the fronted constituent belongs to a non-aboutness-topical category, that is, if it is, for instance, a frame-setter (19a), an interrogative phrase (19b) or a non-topic (here: a negated expression) (19c). Note that in all three examples, the fronted constituents consists of an XP (a PP in (19a–19b), a pronoun in (19c)) modified by an attribute (a relative clause in (19a), a genitival phrase in (19b), a PP in (19c)) and that the post-initial particle intervenes between these two components. This gives rise to the very same configuration as those addressed above.

- (19) a. (*lr-online.de* (news portal), Jun. 17th, 2005)
Am ersten Tag aber, an dem die
on-the-DAT.SG first-DAT.SG day however on REL.DAT.SG the-NOM.SG
„Hängematte“ geschlossen war, standen sie
Hängematte PTCP-close-PTCP be-PST.3SG stand-PST.3PL
wieder vor der Tür.
they-NOM again in-front-of the-DAT.SG door
‘However, on the first day that the *Hängematte* was closed, they were already back in front of the door.’
b. Context: Das Urteil: Schavan hat getäuscht. (‘The verdict: Schavan has cheated (in her PhD).’)
In welchem Kapitel aber ihrer Dissertation hat
in which chapter however her.GEN.FEM dissertation AUX.PRS.3SG
Schavan nun eindeutig plagiiert?
Schavan now clearly plagiarize-PTCP
‘But which parts of her PhD dissertation are unequivocally plagiarized?’ (adapted from: *handelsblatt.com* (news portal), Oct. 15th, 2012)¹³

¹³The original text features a simple interrogative adverb: *Wo aber hat Schavan nun eindeutig plagiiert?* (lit. ‘where however has Schavan now unequivocally plagiarized?’). Irrespective of whether the wh-constituent is split, one may wonder how an interrogative element can receive a contrastive interpretation and how this reading differs from its standard interpretation. For contexts like (19b), it can be assumed that the question of the “where” (‘in which chapter of her dissertation?’) is extracted out of a set of alternatives that are potentially exhausted by all possible wh-elements questioning different aspects of the content introduced in the utterance. In this case, the pre-context provides one further piece of information that is contrasted to the “where” in the second clause, namely the “what” (‘Schavan has plagiarized’).

- c. Context: Wir kennen wohl die Psychologie des Kindes aus Büchern und haben seine Sprache belauschen gelernt, ... ('We arguably know the child's psychology from books, and we have learnt how to eavesdrop on their language...')
- ...keiner aber von uns kennt die
 none-NOM.SG however of we-DAT know-PRS.3SG the-ACC.SG
 Physiognomie des Kindes.
 physiognomy the-GEN.SG child-GEN.SG
 '...none of us, however, knows the child's physiognomy.' (Oskar Kalbus 1935: 130, scientific monograph)

If the analysis proposed for aboutness and contrastive topics is on the right track and in light of the fact that other categories can appear in very similar constructions, it is compelling to assume that the derivation of the patterns in (19) occurs cyclically, i.e., that the left periphery of the clause contains dedicated projections in which the corresponding features are acquired. For a sentence like (19a), for instance, the analysis in (20) follows: the frame is base-generated in the middle field, then moved to Spec,FinP (bottleneck effect) and to Spec,WP (here: the clause-internal projection assumed to encode frame-setting features). This projection is similar to (or, *mutatis mutandis*, the same as) the ModP assumed in Rizzi (2004) (also cf. Samo 2022a, and in particular the discussion in Samo 2022b, where a FrameP and a ModP are considered separately). In the final phase of the derivation, only the segment *am ersten Tag*, which is the contrastively interpreted part of the constituent, is raised to Spec,YP. The particle *aber* is merged in the head of YP:

- (20) [_{ForceP} [_{YP}[+CONTR] [*Am ersten Tag*]_x [_{Y°} *aber*] ... [_{WP}[+FRAME] [[_{t_x}] *an dem die „Hängematte“ geschlossen war*]_j... [_{FinP} _{t_j} [_{Fin°} *standen*]_i] [_{IP/VP} _{t_j} *sie wieder vor der Tür* _{t_i}]]]]]

It comes as little surprise that, just as in (17), the trace left by the frame setter in Spec,FinP can optionally be pronounced as an adverbial resumptive even in the complex construction in (19a) and (20):

- (21) Am ersten Tag aber, an dem die
 on-the-DAT.SG first-DAT.SG day however on REL.DAT.SG the-NOM.SG
 „Hängematte“ geschlossen war, da standen sie
Hängematte PTCP-close-PTCP be-PST.3SG A.RES stand-PST.3PL they-NOM
 wieder vor der Tür.
 again in-front-of the-DAT.SG door
 'However, on the first day that the *Hängematte* was closed, they were already back in front of the door.'

At this point, at least two questions arise: (i) in which relative order do the projections encoding the different grammatical and information-structural features (contrastiveness, topichood, interrogativity) occur in the extended left periphery?; and (ii) which position do non-topics target in the left periphery? These two issues are addressed in the following sections.

4.2 Derivation of non-dislocated frames

In the previous section, it was argued that frame(-like) phrases surfacing in a left-peripheral specifier that can be resumed by a preverbal adverbial element are base-generated in the middle field and cyclically moved into the left edge of the clause and that there is a dedicated position in which the feature [+FRAME] is acquired. The facts presented above entail that the canonical frame-setter position (i.e., the site in which non-contrastively interpreted frames are pronounced, as in (22)) must be positioned in a lower specifier than the one encoding contrastiveness, since WP-to-YP movement is supposed to be implemented only if the frame setter receives a contrastive reading:

- (22) a. Gestern_[NON-CONTR] habe ich Hans getroffen.
yesterday AUX.PRS.1SG I-NOM Hans PTCP-meet-PTCP
‘Yesterday I met Hans.’
b. [_{ForceP} [_{YP} ... [_{WP} *gestern*_j [_{FinP} *t_j* [_{IP/VP} ... *t_j*]]]]]

However, it still has to be clarified where this projection exactly occurs, viz., how it interacts with the other categories addressed above.

4.2.1 Topics and frames

As shown below, moving a frame-setting constituent into the left periphery from its base-generation site in the IP/VP area is not the only possible option. In cases like (4a), (4c) and (4d) (replicated in (23) for the reader’s convenience), this XP seems to be base-generated in the CP area.

- (23) a. Wenn sie schon so ... viel Geld gewonnen
if they-NOM already so much money PTCP-win-PTCP
haben, warum spendieren sie nicht wenigstens
AUX.PRS.3PL why pay-PRS.3PL they-NOM NEG at-least
eine Runde?
one-ACC.SG round
‘If they have won so much money, why don’t they at least pay for a round?’

- b. Heute, die Goethe-Institute in Indien
 today the-NOM.PL Goethe-institute-NOM.PL in India
 heißen alle Max Müller Bhavan.
 be-called-PRS.3PL all-NOM-PL Max Müller Bhavan
 ‘Today, the Goethe institutes in India are all called “Max Müller Bhavan”.’
- c. Piachi, als ihm der Stab gebrochen
 Piachi when he-DAT.SG the-NOM.SG staff PTCP-break-PTCP
 war, verweigerte sich hartnäckig der
 AUX.PST.3SG refuse-PST.3SG REFL.ACC.3SG stubbornly the-DAT.SG
 Absolution.
 absolution
 ‘Piachi, when the staff was broken over him, stubbornly refused absolution.’

In (23a) and (23b) (respectively (4a) and (4c) in Section 3), the frame linearly precedes a *wh*-interrogative (*warum*) or an aboutness topic (*die Goethe-Institute*). These two examples feature different interpretations of the constituent in first clause position: in (23a), the *wenn*-clause introduces a fully presupposed content (“they have won a lot of money”), while *heute* in (23b) has a temporal reference that modifies the predicate BE CALLED and seems to imply a contrastive meaning. Since it is intuitively clear that in these two sentences it is not the frame but the XP in second position that interacts with the V2 syntax of the clause, it is compelling to postulate that the *wenn*-clause and the adverb *heute* are first-merged in their surface position.¹⁴ This is also corroborated by the fact that an obligatory

¹⁴ An anonymous reviewer raises the point about how one can justify not treating both the utterance-initial topic and the *wh*-phrase in structures like (i) (discussed in the literature, e.g., by Boeckx & Grohmann 2005, Ott 2014, Samo 2019) as both moved to the CP layer, given that the former is case-marked:

- (i) (Adapted from Samo 2019: 153, reported as “Hubert Haider, p.c.”)
 Seinen neuen Aufsatz, wann sollen wir den / ihn
 his-ACC.SG new-ACC.SG article when shall.PRS.3SG we-NOM P.RES.ACC.SG / he-ACC
 lesen?
 read-INF
 ‘His new article, when shall we read it?’

It should be considered that the assumption that two XPs can be independently raised to the left periphery in a given structure would amount to the undesirable implication that this should also be the case in other configurations, which clearly does not align with the empirical

prosodic pause intervenes between them and the constituent that linearly follows them in preverbal position. Given the different interpretations of the relevant constituents, a reasonable assumption would be that the *wenn*-clause and *heute* are base-generated in different specialized projections either extra-sententially (KP and JP in (24)) or very high CP-internal positions (GP and HP in (24)).¹⁵ This assumption is in line with Breitbarth's (2022) analysis, which is grounded, *inter alia*, on the empirically observable absence of reconstruction effects and deep embedding in the sentence structure.¹⁶ For reasons of space, I leave the technical details of this intricate differentiation and the corresponding typology for future research, thereby placing the stress on the idea that the surface position of both types of XPs does not result from movement:

- (24) [KP (*wenn*-clause) [JP (*heute*) [ForceP [GP (*wenn*-clause) [HP (*heute*) [...]
[FinP [IP/VP]]]]]]]

In the pattern illustrated in (23c), instead, the frame in second position modifies the predicate by providing a temporal reference for its interpretation and can *under no circumstances* be interpreted contrastively. This aspect is crucial in our discussion, since it excludes that the temporal clause might be positioned in Spec,YP in this sentence (whether its position is supposed to result from movement or not). I propose that in this case, the frame setter is directly base-generated in the specifier that may otherwise host either a moved frame interpreted

observations generally made for present-day German. For structures like (i), I adopt Samo's (2019) idea of what he calls "Case Hanging Topics", namely hanging vPs first-merged above ForceP and replicating the structure of the clause-internal vP that exhibit a portion deleted at PF. For (i) above, Samo assumes the presence of a partially elliptical vP in the outer left periphery interpreted as 'as for reading his new article' and proposes the analysis in (ii). The interested reader is referred to Samo (2019: 146ff.) for the technical details of the derivation:

- (ii) (Samo 2019: 156)
- | | | | | |
|----------------|--------------|------------|------------------|-------------------------|
| [Hanging Topic | Seinen | neuen | Aufsatz lesen, | [ForceP ... wann sollen |
| | his-ACC.SG | new-ACC.SG | article read-INF | when shall.PRS.3SG |
| wir | den | / ihn | lesen]]? | |
| we-NOM | P.RES.ACC.SG | / he-ACC | read-INF | |

¹⁵Note that post-syntactic merger is starkly dispreferred, which is why this construction occurs less frequently than other non-V2 patterns. It is to be noted, however, that the sequence Adverbial > Argument > Vfin is not limited to varieties like Kiezdeutsch (Wiese 2012), but is also present in standard spoken German, as shown, e.g., in the empirical studies by Breitbarth (2022, 2023).

¹⁶Cf. Breitbarth (2022: 21): "The absence of reconstruction and deep embedding indicates that there is no trace in the subsequent clause from which the prepositioning could have originated, which... only allows for the possibility that the clause-initial adverbial modification must have been base-generated outside the subsequent clause," (translation mine).

non-contrastively or the trace of a frame further raised to Spec,YP to receive a contrastive reading. The two assumptions that (i) the position of this XP must be lower than that of topics; and that (ii) this constituent must be base-generated can be tested. In fact, such frames can occur to the right of a contrastive topic ((25a), where the context and the particle in post-initial position concur to disambiguate the interpretation of the DP in first position) or of an aboutness topic ((25b), in this case assuming a corresponding context). What is more, in a complex non-V2 structure like this, the immediate preverbal position (in the present approach: Spec,FinP) can host a pronominal resumptive replicating the features of the DP (here: *der* ‘he.NOM.SG’), but not an adverbial resumptive (here: *dann* ‘then’) taking up the reference of the temporal CP (25c) – irrespective of whether the DP in first position has a contrastive reading. This can be taken to show that the moved element in this linearization must be the DP and cannot be the adverbial clause:

- (25) a. Context: Im Märchen kommt der unbeschwerte Jüngstgeborene, der von den Älteren nicht ganz voll genommen wird und in der Familie leer ausgeht, durch sein gutes Herz draußen in der Welt zum Erfolg. (‘In fairytales, the lighthearted youngest born, who is not taken seriously by their older siblings and is left out in the cold by their family, is successful in the external world by means of his good behavior.’)

Der Erstgeborene hingegen, wenn er den
the-NOM.SG first-born-NOM.SG instead if he-NOM the-ACC.SG
Weg des Glücklichen in krampfhaftem Ehrgeiz
way the-GEN.SG happy-GEN.SG in frantic-DAT.SG eagerness
nachzuahmen versucht, erreicht das gerade
to-emulate-INF try-PRS.3SG reach-PRS.3SG the-ACC.SG exact-ACC.SG
Gegenteil.
opposite

‘When the firstborn instead tries to emulate the path of the happy one with frantic eagerness, he gets the exact opposite.’ (DeReKo, N95/MAI.19855)

- b. ...aber Kinder_[+aboutness], wenn sie es von ihren
but kid-NOM.PL if they-NOM it-ACC from their-DAT.PL
Eltern anders vorgelebt bekommen,
parent-DAT.PL differently V.PRT-PTCP-live-PTCP receive-PRS.3PL

können da sehr grausam untereinander sein.
can-PRS.3PL there very cruel among-each-other be-INF

‘...but children can be cruel to each other if their parents set a different example for them.’ (baby.gofeminin.de (online forum), Feb. 23rd, 2023)

- c. Der Erstgeborene (hingegen), wenn er ... nachzuahmen versucht,
OK_{der}/*dann erreicht das gerade Gegenteil.

‘When the firstborn (instead) tries to emulate the path of the happy one with frantic eagerness, he gets the exact opposite.’

The data suggest that the projection labeled “WP” or “canonical frame position” above and exemplified in (20–22) and (25) must be positioned to the right of both YP and ZP. This projection serves different functions, all linked to framing: run-of-the-mill frames are generated in the middle field and moved to Spec,WP, where they appear at PF unless they are contrastive, in which case they are further moved to Spec,YP. Other types of frames are extrasentential or merged post-syntactically in a very high left-peripheral position. A third strategy consists in generating a frame directly in Spec,WP. In the latter two cases, an adverbial resumptive taking up the reference of the frame cannot be spelled out in Spec,FinP. The derivation of (25c) is sketched in (26):

- (26) [_{ForceP} [_{YP} [_{Der Erstgeborene}]_j [_{Y°} *hingegen*, [_{ZP} _{t_j} [_{WP} *wenn er ... nachzuahmen versucht*, [_{FinP} [_{der}]_j [_{Fin°} *erreicht*_i [_{IP/VP} _{t_j} *das gerade Gegenteil* _{t_i}]]]]]]]]]

In the discussion so far, only contrastive and aboutness topics have been mentioned. Familiar topics, i.e., given, unstressed, often pronominally realized constituents expressing topic continuity (Pesetsky 1987, Givón 1983, Frascarelli & Hinterhölzl 2007), occupy a lower CP position. It is proposed here that familiar topics, unlike contrastive topics, do not need to acquire an aboutness-topical feature before moving to a dedicated specifier encoding a putative [+FAMILIAR] feature. After all, familiar topics are nothing but the spell-out of topic continuity. In non-pro-drop languages like German, such topics are bundles of features phonetically spelled out as weak copies of a topic present in the discourse (viz., in the pre-context). In pro-drop languages, they are generally realized as *pros*. Therefore, they can be reasonably assumed to move from the middle field to Spec,FinP to derive the bottleneck effect and not to undergo any further leftward movement operations. This is independent of the status of the XPs positioned to their left in the CP area. What is crucial with respect to the present discussion, however, is that the sequence “familiar topic > (non-contrastive) frame setter” is not possible.

If a (pronominally realized) topic appears to the left of a frame, it is obligatorily interpreted as a non-familiar, preferably as a contrastive topic, as in (27). This is arguably due to the fact that contrastive, unlike aboutness topics, are associated with a recognizable prosodic contour that disambiguates their reading. Of course, the left-peripheral frame in second position need not be an adverbial clause, but can be also realized by other phrasal categories (for instance by a PP, as in (27b)):

- (27) a. Context: Auf Sam wird in diesem Buch herumgetreten bis zum Gehtnichtmehr, sei dies von den Vampiren, vom Rudel oder Alan.
(‘Sam is heavily trampled on in this book – by the vampires, by the troop, and by Alan.’)
Aber sie, sobald man wieder nett zu ihr
but she-NOM as-soon-as one-NOM again nice to she-DAT
ist, vergisst dies alles ...
be-PRS.3SG forget-PRS.3SG that-ACC all
‘But when she is treated decently again, she forgets that all...’
(amazon.de, Sept. 17th, 2014 (book review))
- b. Und ich, trotz der vier Beine, stürze,
and I-NOM despite the-GEN.PL four leg-GEN.PL tumble-PRS.1SG
falle, fliege durch Raum und Zeit zurück schnurstracks
fall-PRS.1SG fly-PRS.1SG through space and time back directly
zu der Expertin hin.
to the-DAT.SG expert up-to
‘And despite walking with four legs, I tumble, fall, fly through space
and time directly back to the expert.’ (DWDS, WK_1995_2020,
und_ich_’,_trotz_15, aus: Coaching-Blogger, Jul. 05th, 2012)

4.2.2 Interrogatives and frames

Similar observations can be made with respect to the interplay between interrogative pronouns/adverbs and frame setters.

A frame-setting constituent co-occurring left-peripherally with a *wh*-element can surface to the left or to the right of it. In both cases, the presence of an adverbial resumptive in preverbal position is excluded (28a–28b), which suggests that the adjuncts have not been moved into the CP area from a middle-field position. Along the lines of what has been proposed in relation to the interaction between topics and frames, non-dislocated frames can be first-merged either clause-externally/in a very high CP-internal position or in a specifier to the right of the sites encoding topichood and interrogativity. Note that for independent reasons,

the trace left by the interrogative element in Spec,FinP cannot be pronounced in languages like German: this possibility is limited to non-focused referential elements (contrastive, aboutness and frame-setting topics moving through Spec, FinP). It is assumed, however, that run-of-the-mill *wh*-elements are not base-generated in German:

- (28) a. Als du hier an der Kilbi angekommen
 when you-NOM here at the-DAT.SG Kilbi V.PRT-PTCP-come-PTCP
 bist, was (*da) war das Erste,
 AUX.PRS.2SG what A.RES be-PST.3SG the-NOM.SG first-NOM.SG
 das dich begeisterte?
 REL.NOM.SG you-ACC.SG thrill-PST.3SG
 ‘What was the first thing that thrilled you when you arrived at Kilbi
 [= name of a music festival]?’ (wavebuzz.ch (blog), May 31st, 2015)
- b. Warum, wenn der Ofen nicht benutzt wird, (*dann)
 why when the-NOM.SG oven NEG use-PTCP AUX.PRS.3SG A.RES
 ist der Luftstrom oben?
 be-PRS.3SG the-NOM.SG airflow above
 ‘Why is the airflow of the oven even on when it is not used?’
 (manuall.de, Aug. 08th, 2020)

If the interrogative element is contrastive, it can be adjacent to a post-initial particle even when the constituent in second position is a frame setter, as in (29):

- (29) Warum aber, wenn doch das Anliegen aller ein
 why however if PRT the-NOM.SG concern all-GEN.PL a-NOM
 wirksamer Kampf gegen Antisemitismus sein sollte,
 effective-NOM.SG fight against antisemitism be-INF shall-SBJ.3SG
 wird dem Phänomen des BDS hier überhaupt so
 AUX.PRS.3SG the-DAT.SG phenomenon the-GEN.SG BDS here at-all so
 viel Aufmerksamkeit eingeräumt?
 much attention V.PRT-PTCP-concede-PTCP
 ‘But why, if everybody’s concern should be the fight against antisemitism,
 does the BDS phenomenon receive so much attention?’ (*Frankfurter
 Rundschau*, May 13th, 2021)

This is in line with the derivational mechanisms assumed so far: the *wh*-element is merged in the IP/VP domain and moved to Spec,FinP, where its trace blocks any further movement from the lower area, then to a dedicated specifier

in which interrogativity is encoded (FocP in Rizzi's 1997, 2001 model for main clauses; LP in (30) below) and eventually to Spec,YP, in whose head the particle *aber* is spelled out. The *wenn*-clause is base-generated in the lower Spec,WP:

- (30) [_{ForceP} [_{YP} *Warum*_j [_{Y°} *aber*_j [_{LP[+FOC/INT]} *t_j* [_{WP} *wenn doch ... sein sollte*,
[_{FinP} *t_j* [_{Fin°} *wird*_i [_{IP/VP} *dem Phänomen ... t_j* *so viel Aufmerksamkeit*
ingeräumt t_i]]]]]]]]]]]

Although clause-internal (i.e., moved) topics and foci/*wh*-elements can never co-occur in the same sentence in German given that only one constituent can enter the left periphery, for formal reasons I assume two distinct projections for these features (neutrally labeled “ZP_[+TOP]” and “LP_[+WH/INT]”) which both occur to the left of WP_[+FRAME] and match the serialization in Rizzi's model of the Split CP:

- (31) [_{ForceP} [_{YP[+CONTR]} [_{ZP[+TOP]} [_{LP[+WH/INT]} [_{WP[+FRAME]} [_{FinP} [_{IP/VP}]]]]]]]]]

In the non-V2 structures addressed in this section so far, the featural distinction between the two phrases simultaneously occupying the CP area is evident. It is undeniable that, say, an aboutness topic and a frame-setting constituent must be attracted to the left periphery by different features. In the next section, it is shown that some non-V2 patterns including a frame are more ambiguous with respect to their syntactic interpretation.

4.2.3 Potentially ambiguous patterns

In some cases, the structural relation between two (frame-like) adjuncts both positioned in the prefield and thus generating a linear non-V2 configuration is syntactically ambiguous.

To clarify this, let us firstly consider a linear non-V2 pattern in which the derivation is *not* inherently ambiguous. Often, two or more frames occupying the CP area belong to the same or to an analogous semantic cline, like in (32), where temporality (*gestern Abend* ‘yesterday evening’) and locality (*auf dem Weg* ... ‘on my way to ...’) concur to localize the general time-space coordinates of the daring described in the sentence.

- (32) Gestern Abend auf dem Weg zum Sport habe
yesterday evening on the-DAT.SG way to-the-DAT.SG sport AUX.PRS.1SG
ich es gewagt, am Sahlkamp in Hannover auf
I-NOM it-ACC PTCP-dare-PTCP at-the-DAT.SG Sahlkamp in Hanover on

der Fahrbahn zu fahren.
the-DAT.SG road to go-INF

‘Last night, on my way to sports practice, I decided to travel on the road at Sahlkamp (= name of a city district) in Hanover.’ (X, LaSuze, Jun. 27th, 2023)

It is compelling to assume that the two phrases build a “frame-setting complex” generated in the middle field and assembled there (or in a separate workspace) at some point of the derivation. This sentence can be modeled in different ways to demonstrate that the “big frame” resulting from this operation can appear as a block in Spec,YP (33a), in a split configuration within the CP with the temporal XP being raised to Spec,YP and the local one left behind in Spec,WP (33b), as two distinct constituents surfacing respectively in the left periphery and in the IP/VP area (33c) or a complex in the middle field (33d). Moreover, in examples in (33a–33c) it is shown that if at least one of the two phrases is moved into the CP domain, it can optionally be taken up by an adverbial resumptive. If it is true that the two XPs form a big frame when surfacing together in the prefield, it can be assumed that this is a standard case of adverbial dislocation (Section 4.1.1) and that the resumptive has the entire frame as an antecedent (cf. the arguments in Catasso 2021a):

- (33) a. Gestern Abend auf dem Weg zum Sport aber, (da) habe ich es gewagt, am Sahlkamp in Hannover auf der Fahrbahn zu fahren.
b. Gestern Abend aber auf dem Weg zum Sport (da) habe ich es gewagt, am Sahlkamp in Hannover auf der Fahrbahn zu fahren.
c. Gestern Abend (aber) (,) (da) habe ich es auf dem Weg zum Sport gewagt, am Sahlkamp in Hannover auf der Fahrbahn zu fahren.
d. Ich habe es gestern Abend auf dem Weg zum Sport gewagt, am Sahlkamp in Hannover auf der Fahrbahn zu fahren.
‘Last night, on my way to sports practice, I decided to travel on the road at Sahlkamp (= name of a city district) in Hanover.’

In other cases, however, the relation between the two phrases is not as clear, as already pointed out in several works by St. Müller (2003, 2005, 2018). In (34), six sentences are presented that exemplarily illustrate some possible combinations (and serializations) of adverbials in this pattern: modal > temporal (34a), explicative/subject-oriented > concessive (34b), temporal > causal (34c), local > concessive (34d), temporal > final (34e), temporal > concessive (34f):

- (34) a. Aber plötzlich, im Jahre achtzehnhundertzwölf, gab
 but suddenly in-the-DAT.SG 1812 give-PST.3SG EXPL
 es eine große Überraschung.
 a-ACC.SG big-ACC.SG surprise
 ‘But suddenly, in 1812, there was a big surprise.’ (M. Leblanc. 2022.
Arsène Lupin heiratet (novel), p. 66)
- b. Schließlich, trotz allem, was dein Abschlussball-Date
 after-all despite all-DAT.SG REL.ACC.SG your prom-date
 dir sagt, zählen die ersten
 you-DAT.SG tell-PRS.3SG count-PRS.3PL the-NOM.PL first-NOM-PL
 Eindrücke.
 impression-NOM.PL
 ‘After all, despite what your prom date will tell you, it is the first
 impressions that count.’ (demodia.com, 2023, company website)
- c. am Ende aufgrund der Mehrzahl an klaren
 at-the-DAT.SG end because-of the-GEN.SG multitude at clear-DAT.PL
 Torchancen gewinnen wir das ... Viertelfinale ...
 goal-chance-DAT.PL win-PRS.1PL we-NOM the-ACC.SG quarterfinal
 ‘In the end, thanks to a number of goal-scoring opportunities, we
 won [lit. ‘win’] the quarterfinal ...’ (Facebook, ASC GW 49 - 1. Herren,
 Oct. 31st, 2019)
- d. Aber hier, obwohl Verkehrssicherheit ja angeblich so wichtig
 but here although road-safety PRT allegedly so important
 ist, sieht man die Herren
 be-PRS.3SG see-PRS.3SG one-NOM the-ACC.PL gentleman-ACC.PL
 der Ordnungspolizei nicht in Aktion.
 the-GEN.SG Ordnungspolizei NEG in action
 ‘But although road safety is supposed to be very important, you don’t
 get to see the *Ordnungspolizei* gentlemen here.’ (op-online.de, May
 16th, 2022 (online newspaper))
- e. Und heute damit der tag nicht langweilig ist
 and today so-that the-NOM.SG day NEG boring be-PRS.3SG
 spielen wir „HOT OR NOT“.
 play-PRS.1PL we-NOM hot or not
 ‘And today, we will play “HOT OR NOT”, so the day will not get
 boring.’ (Facebook, Frankfurter Twins, May 24th, 2014 [orthography
 and punctuation unmodified])

- f. *damals, trotz 68er-Elan, durfte man beide*
back-then despite 1968 vigor can-PST.3SG one-NOM
als nichtheterosexuell nicht denken oder
both-ACC.PL as non-heterosexual NEG think-INF
wenigstens nur heimlich.
or at-least only secretly
 ‘Back then, despite the 1968 spirit, one was not allowed to think of them as non-heterosexual men, at least not publicly.’ (*taz.de*, January 07th, 2011 (online newspaper))¹⁷

The derivation of structures like those in (34) is apparently ambiguous in the sense that the fact that the two adjuncts belong to distinct semantic clines, i.e., modify the predicate in different ways, makes the idea of a “big frame” assembled in the middle field intuitively less plausible (but, at least in principle, not impossible). If the analysis developed above is on the right track, sentences like these (in particular, their left-peripheral serializations) can possibly be derived in different ways. Let us exemplarily consider (34a) and (34f). These sentences can be modeled such that one (e.g., 35a–36a, 35d–36d), or both XPs (e.g., 35b–36b, 35e–36e) in the CP domain is/are clearly positioned in Spec,YP and that one or both is/are taken up by a preverbal resumptive:

- (35) a. *plötzlich aber, im Jahre achtzehnhundertzwölf gab es ...*
 b. *plötzlich, im Jahre achtzehnhundertzwölf aber gab es ...*

¹⁷An anonymous reviewer notes that YP, ZP, LP and WP refer to positions that could be identified, respectively, as a ContrP, an AboutTopP, a WhP, and a FrameP. To be sure, the use of letters for labeling these projections is an act of prudence. With respect to the projection called “WP” here, for instance, the examples in (34) show that the adverbial in second position in this pattern need not be a frame-setting topic (at least in the mainstream sense). In the following sentence, WP hosts a modal XP:

- (i) *[Ihr Anwalt,] [mit umständlicher Begründung, dringlich und in aller*
their lawyer with sophisticated-DAT.SG motivation pressingly] and in all-DAT.SG
Form beantragte Wahrheitsbeweis
form request.PST.3SG truth-proof
 ‘With a sophisticated argumentation, pressingly and in due form, their lawyer requested a proof of the truth.’ (Lühr 1985: 18)

The question of whether German also exhibits an independent ModP or the projection that is labeled WP here can be assumed to incorporate the functions of a FrameP and a ModP is not addressed in the present paper (cf. the discussion of ex. (20) above) and is left to future research. Thus, for the time being, a rather neutral labeling is chosen over a more descriptive one.

- c. plötzlich, im Jahre achtzehnhundertzwölf, da gab es ...
 - d. plötzlich aber, im Jahre achtzehnhundertzwölf, da gab es ...
 - e. plötzlich, im Jahre achtzehnhundertzwölf aber, da gab es ...
- (36)
- a. damals aber, trotz 68er Elan durfte man beide ...
 - b. ? damals, trotz 68er-Elan aber durfte man beide ...
 - c. damals, trotz 68er Elan, da durfte man beide ...
 - d. damals aber, trotz 68er Elan, da durfte man beide ...
 - e. ?? damals, trotz 68er-Elan aber, da durfte man beide ...

If one considers these two combinations of adverbials, it seems that the resulting variants are not all grammatically acceptable in the same way. In particular, the simultaneous raising of both XPs to Spec,YP produces a less-than-optimal result in (36), while it is unproblematic with the sequence modal > temporal. This suggests that *plötzlich* and *im Jahre achtzehnhundertzwölf* plausibly do build a big frame here and can appear either in the same clausal domain or in different positions. This is probably due to the fact that although *plötzlich* is a modal adverb, its proximity to a time-related meaning implying perfectivity makes it cognitively relatable to – viz. readily interpretable as – a temporal element. This does not seem to be the case instead for *damals* and *trotz 68er Elan*: in (36), the temporal phrase is arguably the one which is first-merged in the middle field and undergoes cyclical movement to the CP area (via Spec,FinP, Spec,WP and – if a contrastive reading occurs – to Spec,YP) and is optionally resumed by an overt trace spell-out (*da*) in preverbal position. Indeed, concessive antecedents are generally not compatible with adverbial resumption. The phrase *trotz 60er Elan* is better analyzed as a segment base-generated in Spec,WP.

In light of this insight, which is not at all self-evident, all the other patterns are easily derivable by means of the mechanisms illustrated in the previous sections. The proposed derivations of (35d) and (36d) (the most complex variants among the examples discussed here) are given in (37) (where the intermediate middle-field operations are not considered for ease of exposition):

- (37)
- a. [_{ForceP} [_{YP} *Plötzlich*_x [_{Y°} *aber* [_{WP} [[_{t_x}] *im Jahre 1812*]_j, [_{FinP} [_{da}]_j [_{Fin°} *gab*_i [_{IP/VP} _{t_j} *es eine große Überraschung* _{t_i}]]]]]]]]]
 - b. [_{ForceP} [_{YP} *Damals*_j [_{Y°} *aber* [_{WP} *trotz 68er Elan*, [_{FinP} [_{da}]_j [_{Fin°} *durfte*_i [_{IP/VP} _{t_j} *man beide als nichtheterosexuell nicht denken* _{t_i}]]]]]]]]]

The general idea conveyed here is that if it is the case that in a given linear non-V2 pattern two adjuncts simultaneously surface in the prefield and these two

phrases are semantically divergent, it cannot be established a-priorily whether they constitute a big frame (i.e., they belong to the class of topicalized XPs addressed in Section 4.1) or only one of them is a moved element, while the other is better analyzed as a non-dislocated adjunct generated in Spec,WP. In order to determine this, factors such as the ones considered with respect to (35) and (36) are to be tested.

4.3 Non-topics

The last category to be reviewed is that of what will be referred to as “non-topics”. This class includes constituents that: (i) are not interrogative/focused, and; (ii) can under no conditions function as sentence topics (in the widest sense), i.e., can be neither frame-setting nor familiar, aboutness or contrastive topics. In (19c) above, an example belonging to this category was illustrated that contains a negated phrase (*keiner von uns* ‘none of us’). Besides negatives (38a), further representatives of this group are quantified (38b) and non-specific indefinite (38c) expressions.

Let us now consider two peculiar characteristics of non-topics. In the first place, as all examples in (38) show, a non-topic appearing in the left periphery cannot be adverbially or pronominally resumed in preverbal position:

- (38) a. An keinem Ort (*, da) konnte man sich
at no-DAT.SG place A.RES can-PST.3SG one-NOM REFL.ACC.SG
verstecken.
hide-INF
‘We could not hide anywhere.’
- b. Alle Studierenden (*, die) haben die
all-NOM.PL student-NOM.PL P.RES.NOM.PL AUX.PRS.3PL the-ACC.SG
Klausur bestanden.
exam pass-PTCP
‘All students passed the exam.’
- c. Einem Hund (*, dem) würde ich so etwas nicht
a-DAT.SG dog P.RES.DAT.SG AUX.SBJ.1SG I-NOM so something NEG
zumuten.
demand-INF
‘I would never demand something like this from a dog.’

Secondly, we have already seen that the corresponding constituents can appear in the specifier of the left-peripheral projection encoding contrastiveness. If

the non-topic is a complex XP (including, for instance, a modifier), the two parts of the phrase can appear in a split configuration in the CP area:

- (39) Einem Menschen aber, der so etwas tut,
 a-DAT.SG person-DAT.SG however REL.NOM.SG so something do-PRS.3SG
 würde ich nicht vertrauen.
 AUX.SBJ.1SG I-NOM NEG trust-INF
 ‘I could not trust someone who says something like that.’

Superficially, non-topics might be thought to have these two properties in common e.g., with *wh*-phrases surfacing in the C-domain. However, a crucial difference between these two categories is that a non-topic cannot plausibly be assumed to acquire a [+NON-TOP] feature in a left-peripheral projection, since this would amount to the absurd assumption that the CP layer hosts a position in which *non-features* are checked. What is more, the semantics of non-topics is too various to allow for a characterization of a putative projection in this sense.

Therefore, I will propose that non-topics, differently from *wh*-interrogatives, undergo Formal Movement to Spec,FinP (and appear there) in the standard case and are further raised to Spec,YP only if the constituent (or a part of it) is interpreted contrastively. In other words, while interrogatives derive the bottleneck effect in Spec,FinP (leaving a non-pronounceable trace) and are then attracted to Spec,LP (cf. 30) and – if the relevant conditions apply – to Spec,YP, non-topics surface in Spec,FinP unless they are attracted by some higher head in order to check an information-structurally-driven feature. Non-topics have this position in common with familiar topics (which are moved there) and expletives (which are base-generated), but the latter two can never be raised to Spec,YP (or to another position to the left of Spec,FinP) since they are not compatible with a contrastive (or some other) reading. Of course, if the left segment of a complex non-topic moves to Spec,YP, the unstressed modifier remains in Spec,FinP and is spelled out in that position. The derivation of (39) is given in (40):

- (40) [_{ForceP} [_{YP} [*Einem Menschen*]_x [_{Y°} *aber* [_{FinP} [[_t]_x *der so etwas tut*]_j [_{Fin°} *würde*_i [_{IP/VP} *ich t_j nicht vertrauen t_i*]]]]]]]]

As a gate into the left periphery, FinP is thus the most crucial of all left-peripheral projections in the present analysis: its specifier serves the derivation of the bottleneck effect, carries the EPP-like feature, hosts some types of constituents first-merged there or raised to that position by Formal Movement; its head attracts the finite verb.

4.4 The spatial limits of the German left periphery

If one tries to realize most of the left-peripheral categories addressed above in one and the same sentence simultaneously, thereby defying the limits of the occupability of the German C-domain, one may produce a structure like the following:

- (41) Dem Kellner aber, der da arbeitet, als
the-DAT.SG waiter however REL.NOM.SG there work-PRS.3SG when
wir angekommen sind, dem habe
we-NOM V.PRT-PTCP-COME-PTCP AUX.PRS.1PL P.RES.DAT.SG AUX.PRS.1SG
ich's gezeigt!
I-NOM-it-ACC PTCP-show-PTCP
‘But the waiter who works there, when we arrived... I owned him!’

Constructions like (41) are of course marked, but still possible, especially in spoken interaction. This sentence makes the lexicalization of the specifier and head positions discussed in this paper visible, as illustrated in the derivation in (42):

- (42) [_{ForceP} [_{YP} [*Dem Kellner*]_x [_{Y°} *aber*, [_{ZP} [[_t]_x *der da arbeitet*]_j [_{WP} *als wir
angekommen sind* [_{FinP} [*dem*]_j [_{Fin°} *habe*_i [_{IP/VP} *ich's t_j gezeigt t_i]]]]]]]]]]*

In this structure, the finite verb is attracted to *Fin°* and the indirect object *dem Kellner, der da arbeitet* (‘the waiter who works there’) is base-generated in the middle field and cyclically moved to Spec,FinP (bottleneck) and then to ZP to acquire a [+TOP] feature. In Spec,FinP, the spell-out of its trace is pronounced as a pronominal resumptive matching the ϕ -features of the dislocate (but – crucially – could also be silent). Subsequently, *dem Kellner* is further raised to Spec,YP, where it checks a [+CONTR] feature. In doing this, it leaves its unstressed (DP-internally extraposed) modifier in Spec,ZP. Note that this modifier is a restrictive relative clause, which excludes the assumption that this constituent could have a parenthetical status. The head position of the projection in whose specifier *dem Kellner* surfaces spells out the post-initial particle *aber*. The frame-like *als*-clause is base-generated in Spec,WP.

5 Conclusions

In this paper, a cartographically-oriented model of the left periphery of German has been proposed that allows the syntactic derivation of a number of complex

prefield serializations. In order to test the hypotheses formulated throughout the discussion, non-V2 patterns – linear V3, V4, V5, etc. – have been considered.

It has been argued that V2 is primarily a *structural*, not (only) a *linear* constraint, and Verb-Late(r) – when it is possible – is a (superficial) variant of this pattern. In other words, the linear component of V2 can be violated, but its structural core is inescapable.

The existence (and the formal investigation) of complex prefields shows that even the left periphery of a well-behaved V2 language may contain multiple projections encoding different features. A combination of Move and Merge warrants the derivability of all possible word orders. German can thus be assumed to have a Split CP à la Rizzi (1997) (with the respective differences having been considered), but its occupation is regulated by stricter rules than in languages like Italian: for instance, it exhibits obligatory V-to-C movement in all run-of-the-mill main clauses and its CP layer shows a so-called “bottleneck effect” and an EPP-like feature which is arguably positioned in a lower position in systems like English and Romance.

What is more, it has been suggested on the basis of data featuring Verb-Late(r) orders that the finite verb moves to Fin, not to Force in German declarative main clauses.

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